



TERACOPIA

UNLOCKING YOUR HIGHEST SELF

The Lucid Dreaming Quick-Start Guide

Your guide to start preparing for your first lucid dream,
without needing to read a whole book on the topic.

By **Quinton Capretta** · teracopia.com

Building the Foundation

Let's start with the basics, giving you a toolkit of practices to start doing today.

The Dream Journal

The first step to lucid dream is to keep a journal by your bedside and make it a priority to write down whatever dreams you can recall the moment you wake up, before you check your phone or start your day. Make sure to write by hand instead of on a screen: when you physically write you're rewarding your mind for remembering in the first place, reinforcing a positive feedback loop. At first, you may only recall fragments, a feeling, a color, a face. Totally fine. Write it down anyway, and the details you remember will grow the more consistently you continue to log each dream.

Writing Intentions

Your subconscious mind is highly malleable, and it takes its cues directly from the information your conscious mind feeds it. The most direct way to imprint on your subconscious mind is to actually tell it what you want, over and over. Each night before bed, write down a short intention a couple times, something like **"the next time I am dreaming, I will realize I'm dreaming"** or **"I am in control of my dreams whenever I want."** It sounds simple because it is; you're giving your subconscious mind a direct instruction to follow.

Reality Checks

If you haven't noticed before, your dream state will feel very similar to your waking life, that is, unless you've built a framework for telling the two apart. Throughout the day, pause and genuinely ask yourself: **am I dreaming right now?** Then test it. Certain patterns behave differently in dreams than they do in our waking life, so use them to your advantage:

- **Light switches:** often won't turn on or off in dreams
- **Clocks:** time will often appear distorted or incorrect
- **Hands:** your hands will usually change shape or morph
- **Breath:** you'll typically be able to breathe through a pinched nose
- **Text:** words will change form or rearrange when you read them back twice

Pick a couple options and perform reality checks throughout the day. The goal is to build a habit that becomes so ingrained in your waking life it will continue through your subconscious into your dreams.

A NOTE ON CONSISTENCY

The work here compounds over time, so give yourself some grace. A daily practice over thirty to fifty days is realistic to reprogram your habits before you can really judge the outcome. Missing a day here and there is normal, we're all human and have busy lives. However, missing two days in a row creates a new, weaker habit that gets reinforced. So if that happens, don't stress, but do start back at day one.

STEP TWO

Your First Method: Wake Back to Bed (WBTB)

Once the dream journal, intentions, and reality checks are running daily, this is the technique to start actively working on.

WAKE BACK TO BED

The process here is straightforward: set an alarm for about five or six hours after you fall asleep. When it goes off, actually get up and do something simple for around ten minutes, like using the bathroom or getting a glass of water. Make sure to stay off your phone, you're not starting your day quite yet, you're tricking your mind into thinking this is a side quest before going back to sleep.

As you lie back down in bed, think of a recent dream you had, ideally one from your journal, and relive it: the setting, the feeling, the details, as if you're experiencing it again right now. Then set a simple intention as you drift off to sleep, something like **"the next time I'm dreaming, I'll realize I'm dreaming."** Hold that thought as you fall back asleep.

This short window puts you back into a REM-heavy window of sleep while your mind is still a little more awake than usual. Your body is ready to sleep, and now your mind is primed to dream, which is exactly what makes this technique so effective.

WBTB is just one of five induction methods we cover in the full guide: WILD, MILD, SSILD and RILD each have their own place for various levels of lucid dreaming.

STEP THREE

Your Quick Reference Guide

Here's the steps in a nutshell to start now:

The Daily Practice

- **Five reality checks** throughout the day
- **Five written intentions** before going to sleep
- **One dream journal entry** upon waking, minimum
- **WBTB** attempts as often as you can, schedule permitting

Consider this just the starting point.

Your Simple Guide to Lucid Dreaming goes deeper: four more induction methods, identifying dream signs, sleep cycle timing, sleep paralysis safety, and much more on how to become lucid and start leveling up in your dreams.

Get the full guide at teracopia.com